

GovSecure

Productized Template Pack

AI Governance Starter Pack for SMBs

Editable templates, fillable sections, practical workflows, and executive-ready structure.

Prepared for	{{CLIENT_NAME}} / {{COMPANY_NAME}}
Edition	{{PACK_VERSION}}
Prepared by	GovSecure
Date	{{PREPARED_DATE}}

Included in this pack: Organization setup sheet, 90-day implementation tracker, AI governance policy template, acceptable use policy, use case intake and risk assessment form, use case registry, shadow AI discovery log, vendor due diligence questionnaire, and leadership one-page brief.

How to Use This Pack

This document is structured as a client-ready working pack. Replace the gray placeholder fields, adapt the policy language to your environment, and delete guidance notes once the final version is approved.

Best practice: Complete the Organization Setup Sheet first. Then update the policies, intake form, and registry using the same naming conventions, owners, and review cadence.

What is inside

- Organization Setup Sheet - baseline business context, roles, approved tools, and implementation ownership.
- 90-Day AI Governance Implementation Tracker - a week-by-week working plan with ownership and status fields.
- AI Governance Policy Template - a practical policy backbone for SMB AI oversight.
- AI Acceptable Use Policy Template - employee-facing rules for safe AI usage.
- AI Use Case Intake & Risk Assessment Form - structured intake, screening, and approval workflow.
- AI Use Case Registry - the central record of AI activity, approvals, and review dates.
- Shadow AI Discovery Log - a workflow and log for identifying unapproved AI usage.
- 3rd-Party AI Vendor Due Diligence Questionnaire - right-sized vendor review structure.
- Leadership One-Page Brief - executive summary template for reporting decisions, risk, and momentum.

Template conventions

Convention	Meaning / expected action
Gray placeholder field	Replace with client-specific content or rename the field as needed.
Prewritten policy language	Keep, trim, or adapt based on risk appetite and business model.
Checkbox / status prompt	Mark manually or replace with your preferred workflow notation.
Owner / review fields	Use named individuals or role titles, but be consistent across the pack.

Template 1 - Organization Setup Sheet

Use this page to anchor the rest of the pack. The information entered here should be reflected across your policies, workflow forms, and leadership reporting.

Business profile and governance ownership

Company name	{{COMPANY_NAME}}
Industry / sector	{{INDUSTRY}}
Employee count	{{EMPLOYEE_COUNT}}
Primary operating regions	{{PRIMARY_REGIONS}}
Executive sponsor	{{EXEC_SPONSOR}}
AI governance lead	{{AI_GOVERNANCE_LEAD}}

Security / privacy reviewer	{{SECURITY_PRIVACY_REVIEWER}}
Implementation start date	{{IMPLEMENTATION_START_DATE}}
Target day-90 date	{{DAY90_TARGET_DATE}}

AI operating context

Approved AI tools / platforms	{{APPROVED_AI_TOOLS}}
Known or suspected shadow AI tools	{{KNOWN_SHADOW_AI_TOOLS}}
Restricted data types	{{RESTRICTED_DATA_TYPES}}
Risk rating scale used	{{RISK_SCALE}}
Policy review cadence	{{POLICY_REVIEW_CADENCE}}
Questions / escalation channel	{{ESCALATION_CHANNEL}}

Template 2 - 90-Day AI Governance Implementation Tracker

How to use: Assign one owner per line, update status weekly, and keep the notes column brutally honest. This tracker is where strategy stops giving TED Talks and starts doing work.

Week	Focus	Owner	Target date	Status	Notes / blockers
1	Confirm sponsor, scope, and working group	{{W1_OWNER}}	{{W1_DATE}}	{{W1_STATUS}}	{{W1_NOTES}}
2	Launch discovery and inventory current AI usage	{{W2_OWNER}}	{{W2_DATE}}	{{W2_STATUS}}	{{W2_NOTES}}
3	Draft governance policy and acceptable use policy	{{W3_OWNER}}	{{W3_DATE}}	{{W3_STATUS}}	{{W3_NOTES}}
4	Capture first wave of use cases in registry	{{W4_OWNER}}	{{W4_DATE}}	{{W4_STATUS}}	{{W4_NOTES}}
5	Finalize intake form and triage criteria	{{W5_OWNER}}	{{W5_DATE}}	{{W5_STATUS}}	{{W5_NOTES}}
6	Approve baseline policies and publish guidance	{{W6_OWNER}}	{{W6_DATE}}	{{W6_STATUS}}	{{W6_NOTES}}
7	Launch vendor	{{W7_OWNER}}	{{W7_DATE}}	{{W7_STATUS}}	{{W7_NOTES}}

	review workflow				
8	Review and classify existing use cases	{{W8_OWNER}}	{{W8_DATE}}	{{W8_STATUS}}	{{W8_NOTES}}
9	Identify and remediate shadow AI usage	{{W9_OWNER}}	{{W9_DATE}}	{{W9_STATUS}}	{{W9_NOTES}}
10	Run employee awareness and policy briefing	{{W10_OWNER}}	{{W10_DATE}}	{{W10_STATUS}}	{{W10_NOTES}}
11	Prepare leadership summary and decisions needed	{{W11_OWNER}}	{{W11_DATE}}	{{W11_STATUS}}	{{W11_NOTES}}
12	Confirm BAU cadence and control ownership	{{W12_OWNER}}	{{W12_DATE}}	{{W12_STATUS}}	{{W12_NOTES}}
13	Close out day-90 report and next-stage roadmap	{{W13_OWNER}}	{{W13_DATE}}	{{W13_STATUS}}	{{W13_NOTES}}

Template 3 - AI Governance Policy Template

Drafting note: This template is written to be practical and SMB-friendly. Adapt the tone and control depth to match your industry, data sensitivity, and regulatory pressure.

Document control

Policy owner	{{POLICY_OWNER}}
Approving authority	{{APPROVING_AUTHORITY}}
Effective date	{{POLICY_EFFECTIVE_DATE}}
Next review date	{{POLICY_REVIEW_DATE}}
Applies to	{{POLICY_APPLIES_TO}}

1. Purpose

This policy establishes how {{COMPANY_NAME}} governs the adoption, approval, and oversight of AI technologies so the business can capture value while managing security, privacy, legal, operational, and reputational risk.

Client customization note: {{1_CLIENT_NOTES}}

2. Scope

This policy applies to employees, contractors, consultants, business units, and third parties using AI tools, AI-enabled features, or AI outputs on behalf of {{COMPANY_NAME}}.

Client customization note: {{2_CLIENT_NOTES}}

3. Governance objectives

The objectives of this policy are to: (a) define accountability, (b) require use-case intake and review, (c) maintain a central registry, (d) review third-party AI risk, and (e) support safe, business-aligned adoption.

Client customization note: {{3_CLIENT_NOTES}}

4. Roles and responsibilities

{{EXEC_SPONSOR}} serves as executive sponsor. {{AI_GOVERNANCE_LEAD}} coordinates the operating process. Business owners remain accountable for the purpose, outcomes, and ongoing suitability of approved use cases.

Client customization note: {{4_CLIENT_NOTES}}

5. Use-case intake and review

All new or materially changed AI use cases must be submitted through the approved intake process before launch, unless expressly exempted in writing by {{APPROVING_AUTHORITY}}. Use cases will be rated {{RISK_SCALE}} and escalated when they involve sensitive data, customer impact, employment decisions, legal or financial outcomes, or significant automation.

Client customization note: {{5_CLIENT_NOTES}}

6. Registry requirement

All submitted, approved, rejected, paused, and retired AI use cases must be recorded in the AI Use Case Registry with an owner, risk level, approval status, review date, and required controls.

Client customization note: {{6_CLIENT_NOTES}}

7. Vendor due diligence

AI vendors and AI-enabled service providers must undergo a right-sized review covering security, privacy, data handling, contractual protections, retention, subprocessors, and incident response before purchase or production use.

Client customization note: {{7_CLIENT_NOTES}}

8. Human oversight

High-impact or externally facing AI outputs must be reviewed by an accountable human prior to use in decisions that could materially affect customers, employees, finances, contracts, compliance, or safety.

Client customization note: {{8_CLIENT_NOTES}}

9. Monitoring and revalidation

Approved use cases must be re-evaluated when the purpose, data used, vendor, model, user population, or downstream decision impact changes, or when an incident, complaint, or control failure occurs.

Client customization note: {{9_CLIENT_NOTES}}

10. Exceptions and violations

Any exception to this policy requires documented approval. Misuse of AI tools, bypassing review, or entering restricted data into unapproved tools may result in remediation, tool restrictions, disciplinary action, or other corrective measures.

Client customization note: {{10_CLIENT_NOTES}}

Template 4 - AI Acceptable Use Policy Template

Use case: This template is intended for employee-facing communication. Keep it plain, direct, and enforceable. Fancy words are optional; clarity is not.

Document control

Audience	{{AUP_AUDIENCE}}
Policy owner	{{AUP_OWNER}}
Effective date	{{AUP_EFFECTIVE_DATE}}
Questions / reporting channel	{{AUP_CONTACT_CHANNEL}}

Permitted use

Employees may use approved AI tools for low- and medium-risk business activities such as drafting, summarization, brainstorming, knowledge assistance, or productivity support, subject to this policy and all applicable company policies.

Prohibited data

Employees must not enter {{RESTRICTED_DATA_TYPES}} into unapproved AI tools or any AI tool where contractual, technical, or policy controls do not permit such data handling.

Output review

AI outputs must be reviewed by the user for accuracy, bias, confidentiality, appropriateness, and business fit before being shared or relied upon.

Restricted decisions

Employees may not use AI outputs as the sole basis for decisions involving hiring, termination, legal advice, regulated obligations, customer rights, pricing, credit, safety, or any other significant impact area without approved oversight controls.

Shadow AI

Employees must not procure, connect, or use AI tools for company work outside approved channels without disclosure and review.

Incident reporting

Suspected data exposure, harmful output, unauthorized use, or other AI-related issues must be reported immediately through {{AUP_CONTACT_CHANNEL}}.

Consequences

Failure to follow this policy may result in access restriction, remediation requirements, disciplinary action, or other measures consistent with company policy.

Employee acknowledgement block

Employee name	{{EMPLOYEE_NAME}}
Role / department	{{EMPLOYEE_ROLE}}
Acknowledgement date	{{ACK_DATE}}
Manager or function lead	{{MANAGER_NAME}}

Template 5 - AI Use Case Intake & Risk Assessment Form

Workflow note: This form is designed to be completed by the requestor and then reviewed by security, privacy, legal, and business stakeholders as needed.

Section A - request and ownership

Use case name	{{USE_CASE_NAME}}
Requestor / business owner	{{REQUESTOR_NAME}}
Department / function	{{REQUESTOR_DEPARTMENT}}
Requested launch date	{{REQUESTED_LAUNCH_DATE}}
AI tool / vendor	{{AI_TOOL_VENDOR}}
Internal or external use	{{INTERNAL_OR_EXTERNAL_USE}}

Section B - business case

Business problem being solved	{{BUSINESS_PROBLEM}}
Expected value / benefit	{{EXPECTED_BENEFIT}}
Users affected	{{USERS_AFFECTED}}
Customer-facing or employee-facing	{{CUSTOMER_OR_EMPLOYEE_FACING}}
Key outputs produced by AI	{{AI_OUTPUTS}}

Section C - data and control questions

Data inputs used	{{DATA_INPUTS}}
Data sensitivity level	{{DATA_SENSITIVITY}}
Connects to internal systems?	{{CONNECTS_INTERNAL_SYSTEMS}}
Uses personal, regulated, or confidential data?	{{USES_SENSITIVE_DATA}}
Human review before action?	{{HUMAN_REVIEW_REQUIRED}}

Section D - risk screening

Risk screening question	Response
Could the output materially affect customers, employees, finances, contracts, or compliance?	{{RISK_Q1}}
Could the tool expose or retain sensitive data in a way the business cannot accept?	{{RISK_Q2}}
Does the use case automate or heavily influence important decisions?	{{RISK_Q3}}
Is additional legal, privacy, or security review required?	{{RISK_Q4}}
Recommended overall risk level	{{OVERALL_RISK_LEVEL}}

Section E - approval outcome

Decision	{{INTAKE_DECISION}}
Approver(s)	{{INTAKE_APPROVERS}}
Required controls / conditions	{{REQUIRED_CONTROLS}}
Next review date	{{USE_CASE_REVIEW_DATE}}

Template 6 - AI Use Case Registry

The registry should be treated as the operating center of the program. Every approved, pending, paused, rejected, or retired use case should show up here with enough detail to support review and leadership reporting.

Registry discipline: If the use case is not in the registry, governance is mostly just a PowerPoint hobby.

#	Use case	Business owner	Tool / vendor	Data type	Risk	Status	Last review	Next review	Required controls
1	{{REG_1_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_1_OWNER}}	{{REG_1_TOOL}}	{{REG_1_DATA}}	{{REG_1_RISK}}	{{REG_1_STATUS}}	{{REG_1_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_1_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_1_CONTROLS}}
2	{{REG_2_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_2_OWNER}}	{{REG_2_TOOL}}	{{REG_2_DATA}}	{{REG_2_RISK}}	{{REG_2_STATUS}}	{{REG_2_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_2_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_2_CONTROLS}}
3	{{REG_3_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_3_OWNER}}	{{REG_3_TOOL}}	{{REG_3_DATA}}	{{REG_3_RISK}}	{{REG_3_STATUS}}	{{REG_3_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_3_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_3_CONTROLS}}
4	{{REG_4_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_4_OWNER}}	{{REG_4_TOOL}}	{{REG_4_DATA}}	{{REG_4_RISK}}	{{REG_4_STATUS}}	{{REG_4_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_4_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_4_CONTROLS}}
5	{{REG_5_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_5_OWNER}}	{{REG_5_TOOL}}	{{REG_5_DATA}}	{{REG_5_RISK}}	{{REG_5_STATUS}}	{{REG_5_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_5_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_5_CONTROLS}}
6	{{REG_6_USE_CASE}}	{{REG_6_OWNER}}	{{REG_6_TOOL}}	{{REG_6_DATA}}	{{REG_6_RISK}}	{{REG_6_STATUS}}	{{REG_6_LAST_REVIEW}}	{{REG_6_NEXT_REVIEW}}	{{REG_6_CONTROLS}}

Template 7 - Shadow AI Discovery Workflow and Log

Recommended workflow

- Identify suspected unapproved AI tools through user interviews, procurement signals, browser or SaaS reviews, and manager disclosure.
- Confirm the business owner, purpose, and what data is being entered or connected.
- Determine whether the tool is already approved, conditionally acceptable, or prohibited.
- Assign a risk level and decide whether to allow, replace, restrict, or stop the usage.
- Track remediation owners, dates, and communication actions in the log below.

Tool / workflow	Owner / team	Data involved	Source of discovery	Risk	Decision / action	Due date	Status
{{SHADOW_1_TOOL}}	{{SHADOW_1_OWNER}}	{{SHADOW_1_DATA}}	{{SHADOW_1_SOURCE}}	{{SHADOW_1_RISK}}	{{SHADOW_1_ACTION}}	{{SHADOW_1_DATE}}	{{SHADOW_1_STATUS}}
{{SHADOW_2_TOOL}}	{{SHADOW_2_OWNER}}	{{SHADOW_2_DATA}}	{{SHADOW_2_SOURCE}}	{{SHADOW_2_RISK}}	{{SHADOW_2_ACTION}}	{{SHADOW_2_DATE}}	{{SHADOW_2_STATUS}}
{{SHADOW_3_TOOL}}	{{SHADOW_3_OWNER}}	{{SHADOW_3_DATA}}	{{SHADOW_3_SOURCE}}	{{SHADOW_3_RISK}}	{{SHADOW_3_ACTION}}	{{SHADOW_3_DATE}}	{{SHADOW_3_STATUS}}
{{SHADOW_4_TOOL}}	{{SHADOW_4_OWNER}}	{{SHADOW_4_DATA}}	{{SHADOW_4_SOURCE}}	{{SHADOW_4_RISK}}	{{SHADOW_4_ACTION}}	{{SHADOW_4_DATE}}	{{SHADOW_4_STATUS}}
{{SHADOW_5_TOOL}}	{{SHADOW_5_OWNER}}	{{SHADOW_5_DATA}}	{{SHADOW_5_SOURCE}}	{{SHADOW_5_RISK}}	{{SHADOW_5_ACTION}}	{{SHADOW_5_DATE}}	{{SHADOW_5_STATUS}}

Template 8 - 3rd-Party AI Vendor Due Diligence Questionnaire

Positioning note: Most SMBs buy AI rather than build it. That makes vendor diligence one of the highest-leverage controls in the entire pack.

Section A - profile

Vendor name	{{VENDOR_NAME}}
Product / service	{{VENDOR_PRODUCT}}
Internal business owner	{{VENDOR_BUSINESS_OWNER}}
Proposed use case	{{VENDOR_USE_CASE}}
Review date	{{VENDOR_REVIEW_DATE}}

Question area	Response / notes
What data will the vendor process, store, or generate?	{{VQ_DATA_SCOPE}}

Will customer or business data be used to train the vendor model?	{{VQ_TRAINING_USE}}
Can training on submitted data be disabled?	{{VQ_TRAINING_DISABLE}}
Where is data stored and processed?	{{VQ_DATA_LOCATION}}
What retention and deletion controls are available?	{{VQ_RETENTION}}
What security certifications, reports, or independent assurance exist?	{{VQ_ASSURANCE}}
What subprocessors are used?	{{VQ_SUBPROCESSORS}}
How does the vendor handle incidents and customer notification?	{{VQ_INCIDENTS}}
What contractual protections are required?	{{VQ_CONTRACTS}}
Overall review outcome	{{VQ_OUTCOME}}

Template 9 - Leadership One-Page AI Brief

Use this page for leadership, founders, or the board. Keep it short, numeric where possible, and decision-oriented.

Reporting period	{{BRIEF_PERIOD}}
Prepared by	{{BRIEF_PREPARED_BY}}
Executive sponsor	{{BRIEF_SPONSOR}}

AI footprint summary {{BRIEF_AI_FOOTPRINT}}	Top risks and issues {{BRIEF_TOP_RISKS}}
Decisions needed {{BRIEF_DECISIONS}}	Next 30-60-90 days {{BRIEF_NEXT_STEPS}}

Metrics snapshot	{{BRIEF_METRICS}}
Requested leadership action	{{BRIEF_ACTION_REQUEST}}